

Module 4 Assignment

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Social Networking Sites

Nowadays there are many different social networking sites and new ones appearing every day. A very common networking site that I run into frequently is LinkedIn. LinkedIn is a social networking site that is specifically designed for business networking and offers people within similar professions a way to connect.

Noticeably, as I was looking through the settings there were many settings to help prevent social engineering and increase your security. To explain, there is a section in the settings for security, data privacy, and visibility. Within the security section of the settings you can create and manage passkeys, such as biometric methods, to increase your security. There is another setting for managing all of the locations where you are signed in at and where your passwords are remembered.

Within the other two sections there are multiple settings for the user to increase the security of their account and information. For example, the data privacy section contains a segment of settings that allow you to manage the data that linkedin uses. On top of that there is a section that allows you to control the data that other people can see as well. The visibility section of settings is similar to this one because it is just full of settings that control what information on your profile is visible to other people. All of these settings are important and can help protect the users information extremely.

Many of these settings were suggested in the book for people to use to increase their security. For example, one of the suggestions that the book makes is, “users should be cautious regarding who can view their information” (Ciampa, 2023). The settings that linkedin gives users allows them to do this for a few reasons. One reason is because the visibility and data privacy

sections offer multiple settings, allowing the user to conceal any information. Not only that, but they also offer settings protecting your information from them.

Password Management Programs

One password management program that seems to be highly regarded is NordPass. NordPass is an online password management program that has two versions. The first version they have is free and only gives you access to some features. The second version costs around \$44 a year, but offers way more features.

The free version of NordPass only gives you access to a few of their features. These include autosaving and auto filling passwords along with saving passwords, passkeys, and credit cards. However, the upgraded version offers many more features along with the basic features. Some features are detecting weak or reused passwords, and scanning the web for data breaches. There is one feature that I don't think is a very secure feature and that is the feature they offer of staying signed in when switching devices. I don't think this is secure because I can see this easily causing a breach if you accidentally use it on a public computer.

One way that NordPass ensures your passwords are protected is one of the features mentioned earlier, scanning the web for data breaches. This actively ensures that your passwords are protected because the moment it detects a breach on the web it will notify you. Another way that they ensure your protection is with a feature offered, email masking. What this feature does is it puts a unique mask on your email when you enter it into a website, which reduces your risk of having your email leaked out.

I think that NordPass is a good password management program and I might give the free version a try. I think I would even pay for the upgraded version in the future because of all the

extra features they have. Some of these features I wouldn't use but the ones that I would end up using would be great for increasing my security.

Email Phishing Attack

The major email phishing attack I investigated was the 2014 Sony Pictures Leak. This leak was “over 100 Terabytes containing confidential company activities... resulting in well over \$100 million lost” (Town of Hempstead, n.d.). This happened by the attackers pretending to be friends with high-level employees. After receiving their emails the attackers sent a fake apple ID verification email which contained the attack. The suspected attackers were a small group from North Korea and this attack actually forced Sony to cancel the release of *The Interview* (Ponce, 2020).

In this attack the targeted group was Sony and high-level employees. I could not find anything on how many emails were sent during the attack, Although, according to Hempstead “Through a combination of LinkedIn data and Apple ID logins, the phishers managed to find passwords that matched the ones used for the Sony network”(Town of Hempstead, n.d.). The response rate in the high-level employees was obviously high enough for the attackers to get the information that they needed for the attack.

This attack was extremely successful. A group suspected from North Korea known as The Guardians of Peace executed this attack. Sony first noticed they were attacked when all of the screens in their office started flashing red and showing The Guardians of Peace's message. They had already taken around 100 terabytes of confidential data and threatened to release it to the public. One effect of this was that the new release “‘Fury’ would face an illegal download issue for more than 1 million times”(Ponce, 2020). This movie was some of the data stolen and

distributed from the hack. A few days after the initial attack, The Guardians of Peace released the salary of “17 SPE higher executives along with 6000 employees and their dependents” (Ponce, 2020). These salaries were quickly published in major media.

This attack is known as one of the worst cyberattacks in the United States. This is because of the amount of damage and the size of the attack. This resulted in Sony losing millions of dollars to fix all issues caused by the attack. The funny thing about this attack was that one of the reasons they got the passwords for the Sony network was because it was a similar one used to the ones on their personal accounts. Additionally, I also find this very interesting because I love the movie and the interview and this is tied to that.

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